

```
Spelling";
    return 0;
}
```

Now instead of submitted simply the corrected file and letting the developers guess the difference (think 3000 line file), you create a “patch” file, via the following command.

```
diff digit.cpp digit1.cpp > patchfile.patch
```

diff is the name of the command.

digit.cpp is the incorrect one file and **digit1.cpp** is your corrected file.

> is the output redirector, which means that you are telling the computer to store the output of the “diff digit.cpp digit1.cpp” command in a file called “patchfile.patch” instead of displaying it on your monitor. “patchfile.patch” is your patch file as the name suggest.

You can now submit this file to the developers via the official mailing list which can be found on their project web site.

The developer now looking at the contents of the “patchfile.patch” can easily make out that there was an error in the fourth line and what was the error:

```
4c4
<  std::cout<<"This is the correct
Spelling";
---
>  std::cout<<"This is the correct
Spelling";
```

They can then without having to manually correct the code, issue the following command to produce and updated version

```
patch digit.cpp -i patchfile.patch -o digit_
corrected.cpp
```

This way, as explained above, in the version control system they can maintain a continuous log of what changes are being made and by whom, so that you get appropriate credit for your efforts, and if the developer find you ninja enough they might give you write access to their svn/cvs repositories where you can directly commit the changes.